

Oil spills

This bird, called a cormorant, is stuck in a layer of oil. Oil spills from ships pollute the waters and poison wildlife.

The Great Pacific Garbage Patch

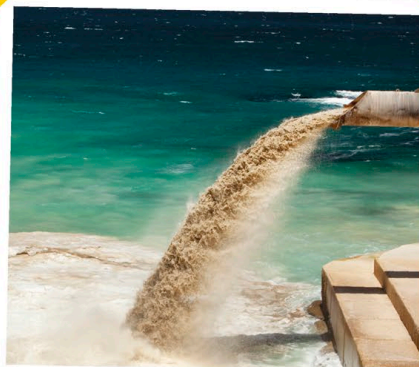
Ocean currents have trapped huge amounts of litter and waste in the North Pacific Ocean. Known as the Great Pacific Garbage Patch, this area is bigger than the US, and mostly contains plastics since they do not wear down naturally.



Triggerfish swimming in an ocean of plastic

Whaling

The whaling trade has dramatically reduced global whale populations. There are strict rules to limit whaling, but whales are still hunted for their meat, oil, and bones.



Chemical waste in Morocco is dumped into the Atlantic Ocean.

Pollution

Every day, human activity creates sewage, chemicals, and other waste, which end up dumped in the oceans. This is extremely harmful to marine animals and their habitats.